

## Deciding where to invest

You work for an international bank and you are selecting a major new investment project. What criteria do you use to make your choice? You are not only choosing the project itself, but at the same time the country or region where the project will be realised.

Look at this set of criteria and decide which criteria are:

1. Very important
2. Quite important
3. Not very important

Then choose the **THREE** which you think are most important.

- a) Political stability in the country or region concerned
- b) The climate
- c) The viability of the project
- d) The level of development of the country or region
- e) The availability of subsidies
- f) The return on investment
- g) The friendliness of the local people
- h) The duration of the loan
- i) The amount of investment you already have in the country or region
- j) Who your partners will be
- k) The life expectancy of the local people
- l) Exchange rate variations
- m) Religious beliefs and practices
- n) Guarantees

## Language for Discussion

|                              |                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Start the discussion</b>  | <i>OK, we've decided to talk about...</i><br><i>Right, let's discuss...</i><br><i>Now, our task is to...</i>                                                                     |
| <b>Elicit ideas</b>          | <i>What is your opinion regarding...?</i><br><i>What do you think about ...?</i><br><i>Have you any views on...?</i>                                                             |
| <b>Express your opinion</b>  | <i>In my opinion...</i><br><i>The way I see it...</i><br><i>To my mind...</i><br><i>If you ask me...</i><br><i>From my point of view...</i><br><i>As far as I'm concerned...</i> |
| <b>Respond to ideas</b>      | <i>Can I pick up on what you said about...?</i><br><i>Have you considered...?</i><br><i>But what about...?</i>                                                                   |
| <b>Ask for clarification</b> | <i>I'm not sure I follow you. Did you say...?</i><br><i>Sorry, I'm not sure I understand. Do you mean...?</i><br><i>Can you be a little more specific?</i>                       |
| <b>Restate your point</b>    | <i>The point I'm trying to make is...</i><br><i>What I mean to say is...</i><br><i>To put it another way...</i>                                                                  |
| <b>Add a point</b>           | <i>Let me add that...</i><br><i>Another point worth mentioning is...</i><br><i>And another thing to remember is...</i>                                                           |
| <b>Interrupt</b>             | <i>Just out of interest...</i><br><i>I'm just curious about...</i><br><i>Can I just say...</i>                                                                                   |
| <b>Agree on a point</b>      | <i>I agree with you on that point.</i><br><i>That's a fair suggestion.</i><br><i>You have a strong point there.</i><br><i>I think we can both agree that...</i>                  |
| <b>Object to a point</b>     | <i>I understand where you're coming from; however,...</i><br><i>I'd have to disagree with you there.</i><br><i>I'm afraid I don't entirely agree with you.</i>                   |
| <b>Summarize discussion</b>  | <i>Well, so far we've decided...</i><br><i>Would you agree...?</i>                                                                                                               |